

API Authentication

Backend development study note for document retrieval and grounded question-answering practice.

Authentication

Authentication is the process of establishing or verifying an identity. An API may authenticate a user or service using credentials, sessions, or tokens.

Bearer tokens

A bearer token is commonly sent in the Authorization header using the Bearer scheme. Possession of the token grants the capabilities associated with it, so tokens must be protected and transmitted over HTTPS.

Token validation

A receiving service or trusted gateway should validate token integrity and relevant claims, such as issuer, audience, and expiration, according to the token format and security design.